

Newark's Bears are gone but the memory lingers on

By JIM OGLE

It has been a long time since Newark made much of an impression in the sports world, but there must have been something to the old place at one time. Go touring around the country and sooner or later Newark will pop into the conversation.

Take Andy Cohen, a real wanderer on the baseball map. He still remembers the cup he won as the Most Popular Player in 1931. Bennie Bengough, another who really travelled the diamond trail, still has a shaving set presented to him in Newark a couple of decades ago.

"That was quite a town," Bengough says with a chuckle. "The best minor league city in the country and what ball clubs. I'll never forget the couple of days when Bob Seeds was belting homers over the fence in Buffalo like flipping seeds over the porch railing.

AN UMPIRE'S TALE

"I broke in with Buffalo," Bennie recalls. "It wasn't the same park, but the ball seemed to carry just as well. I came into Newark the year after the 'wonder team' and had a lot of fun. We didn't win as easily, but we sure won enough. I still have the shaving outfit they gave me in Newark."

You meet Charlie Berry, veteran umpire, and he has a tale of Newark in his vast store of stories.

"I got a job from Tommy Richardson to break in as an umpire with the Eastern League," Berry begins. "The Eastern clubs didn't need umpires in spring training so I went south with Lena Blackburne and the Toronto club to get a little practice as an umpire.

"One day we went over to Schring to play Newark," Charlie recalls. "I worked the game. Frank Shaughnessy saw me that day and asked if I would work the exhibition games all spring since he was an umpire short. I did, then it came time for the season to open.

"Shag wanted to know if I could get out of my contract with the Eastern League," Berry said. "I knew it would mean more money and a step up so I told him I would try.

"I called Richardson and said you wouldn't keep a man from bettering himself would you," Berry recalled. "Naturally Tommy said 'Certainly not, why?' Then I told him, thanks, I have an offer from the International League that I want to take.

"I was working in Newark one day with Shaughnessy in the stands," Berry went on. "George Stinweiss came barreling into the plate, where the catcher was holding the ball. Stinweiss hit him and the catch out but still hiding the ball. Then, I saw his grip relax, the ball rolled out and I called Stinweiss safe. That started a real riot, but Shag backed me up.

"That Newark was quite a town and what ball clubs."

Yogi Berra is the last remaining link between Newark and the Yankees and even Yogi, although he played with the Bears only in 1946, has a few memories.

"I learned a lot of things in

Newark," Yogi says with a grin. "I learned never to try to get one more swing after the bell ends batting practice. I did that one night and that extra pitch broke my wrist.

"I also learned not to lose my temper," Berra says. "Remember the last game in the playoffs when Artie Gore made that bad call at the plate and we all rushed him and I guess I shoved him a little. You know I got a whale of a fine that night."

We remembered the occasion

perfectly, but this was the first time word of the fine leaked out. "Sure, five of us were fined that night and pretty good, too!" Yogi continued.

"I also remember I went 0 for 32 in Newark," Yogi said. "I'll never forget that stretch. I was sure that I was a flop, but then I started hitting again." That's the way it goes. You can always meet someone who remembers Newark in its hey day. The city may be gone from the sports scene but, apparently, it will never be forgotten.



A friendly pot KOs Dupas

Rep. F. Edward Hebert's charge that Ralph Dupas' contract will be sliced more than the baloney spouted at any fight managers' gathering probably has blown his New Orleans constituent right out of a lightweight title shot. In fact, this fresh incident, on top of other investigations and the federal monopoly suit, probably will kill the fight entirely.

The National Boxing Association, which reluctantly approved a Dupas fight with champion Joe Brown at Houston, Texas, May 7, now can be expected to seize the opportunity of withholding title recognition from the bout.

Hebert (D-La.), demanding a congressional probe of boxing, perhaps intended his blast as a plug for Dupas but its ill-timing will hurt more than it will help. He said the New Orleans lightweight sought a title match for several years and has "won the right and deserves the chance to fight the champion." At the time he uttered these words Dupas already had been signed for the championship shot.

If Dupas wins the title, the congression said, his contract will be cut into seven pieces, meanwhile rapping "monopolistic bloodsuckers" and the International Boxing Club.

One boxer who may find Hebert's statement rueful and ironic is Kenny Lane. Lane, No. 1 rated challenger, had been shunted aside for Dupas as a Brown opponent after the National Boxing Association had ordered a Brown-Lane bout or suspension for the champion.

The ultimatum suffered a rude shock when Julius Helfand of the N.Y. boxing commission and chairman of the World Championship Committee, stated he saw no objection to Dupas getting the match ahead of Lane. As noted in an earlier column on the subject, Helfand thereby yanked the rug from under the NHA.

The NBA subsequently had a re-vote and accepted Brown but swiftly retaliated by withdrawing from the World Championship Committee.

That the shoddy gang hovering around the Texas fight finds support from New York sources should be intrinsically stimulating to boxing crusaders.

NBA has another chance to stand up

The NBA has a ready out in ignoring the Brown-Dupas fight. As a face-saving gesture, after the New Orleans fighter had been installed as opponent over its official head, it ordered the principals to post a \$5,000 forfeit. This would guarantee Lane a chance at the winner. Brown has deposited his \$5,000 but not Dupas, whose "representative," Angelo Dundee, is now in Europe on a tour with Willie Pastrano, another New Orleans fighter.

Hebert alleges that Dupas' manager on record, Whitey Esneault, had to cut in Dundee, and others, as the price for getting the title fight. He said Esneault now will receive a tenth of the challenger's purse and that Dupas will be lucky to get 50 per cent.

Dupas took a contrary view. He defended Angelo Dundee as "always a straight guy with me." He said Dundee has been managing only his out-of-town fights because Esneault is crippled and unable to travel. Dupas told a reporter he always had got 50 per cent of his purse after expenses had been deducted.

Chris Dundee, Angelo's brother and a Miami promoter, said Dupas received two-thirds after expenses and that the managers split the remainder 50-50 between them. Angelo Dundee has been with Dupas since 1952. Angelo probably is better known as regular trainer for middleweight champion Carmen Basilio and was in his corner for the recent Ray Robinson fight.

The Louisiana lightweight says nobody had talked to him about additional managerial cuts and would select such